Fiscal Year:	FY 2025	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 01/02/2025
PI Name:	Walker, Travis Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Investigation of Aspherical Magnetic Particles in Low-Gravity Environments		
Division Name:	Physical Sciences		
Program/Discipline:			
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	COMPLEX FLUIDS/SOFT MATTER--Complex Fluids		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
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Zip Code:	57701-3901	**Congressional District:**	1
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground,Physical Sciences Informatics (PSI)	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2017/2019 Physical Sciences NNH17ZTT001N-17PSI-F: Use of the NASA Physical Sciences Informatics System – Appendix F
Start Date:	12/22/2020	**End Date:**	12/21/2023
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	1
No. of PhD Candidates:	1	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	0	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	1
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	2	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA GRC
Contact Monitor:	McQuillen, John	**Contact Phone:**	216-433-2876
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Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:	NOTE: End date changed to 12/21/2023 per NSSC information (Ed., 1/12/23)		
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	Per the Principal Investigator (PI) Mingyang Tan, Ph.D. is a CoInvestigator on this project. Dr. Tan is based at the University of Connecticut (Ed., 9/14/23).		
COI Name (Institution):	Tan, Mingyang (University of Connecticut)		
Grant/Contract No.:	80NSSC21K0293		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:	Magnetorheological fluids that are composed of suspensions of magnetic micro-/nano-particles are providing numerous opportunities for applications as smart fluids with properties that are tunable when subjected to external magnetic fields. However, investigations of these fluids are inhibited on Earth by the sedimentation of the particles that is caused by their inherent difference in density from the surrounding media. In this work, we use accelerated Stokesian dynamics simulations to investigate the dynamics and properties of coarsening of spherical and aspherical magnetic particles under different magnetic fields, and we compare our numerical results with experimental data of InSPACE, InSPACE-2, InSPACE-3, and InSPACE-3+.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	Successful completion of this project could provide fundamental understanding of physics of magnetorheological (MR) fluids beyond the dynamics of coarsening of particles, e.g., the kinetics of phase transition, the transport properties of the system, the macroscopic magnetic properties of the overall system, and the microscopic magnetic properties of the local environment. Further, this work will not only predict the dynamics and rheological properties of MR fluids that were observed in InSPACE, InSPACE-2, InSPACE-3, and InSPACE-3+, but it will also provide insights into unexplored systems that are commonly seen in real applications. Beyond the fundamental knowledge of physics in MR fluids, advanced theoretical and numerical modeling and experimental validation of the behavior of MR fluids are also expected to provide robust metrics for the design of future MR systems. These systems could be applied in manufacturing of magnetic soft composites or in transporting therapeutic drug and gene delivery through tumor vasculature. Completion of this project can also be expected to direct future opportunities focusing on fundamental and applied aspects of making anisotropic composites, such as switchable anisotropic conductive barriers, magneto-optical devices, and liquid crystals, as well as opportunities to produce composite hydrogels using 3D additive manufacturing techniques. The Principal Investigator (PI) is currently modeling the microhydrodynamics of oblate spheroids in Newtonian fluids in collaboration with faculty in electrical engineering at Oregon State University (OSU) to engineer soft composites for high- frequency applications such as inductor and antennae. Anisotropic magnetic particles were chosen in this problem to enhance the magnetic properties, i.e., increased permeability of materials at high resonance frequency that allows for high-data-transmission rate. Completion of this work is projected to significantly impact efforts to perform voxel-by-voxel additive manufacturing via 3D printing of UV-curable magnetic inks. The PI is also studying a novel technique of micro-/nano-rheology, which measures magnetic susceptibility as a function of frequency of a magnetic colloidal suspension that is subjected to an oscillating magnetic field. The frequency-dependent magnetic susceptibility can be related to the rheological properties of the suspension. This work is expected to provide a novel method to measure the rheological properties of fluids that are difficult to measure in conventional macroscopic or microscopic rheological methods, e.g., in a limited amount of sample to collect for macroscopic rheological measurements or for an opaque sample that cannot be measured by conventional microscopic rheological methods that require visualization of the sample. The PI is funded by the NASA Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research (EPSCoR) R3 to investigate microbial growth in rotating wall vessels by utilizing conventional Stokesian dynamics. Incorporation of accelerated Stokesian dynamics would advance the computational understanding of particle sedimentation, allowing detailed three-dimensional trajectories to be compared to fundamental theoretical calculations, which would verify our predictions of mass transfer during the introduction of an external stimulus. Completion of this work is projected to develop an in vivo technique for analysis of bio-fluids or tissues of patients by monitoring the change of rheological properties. The modeling and numerical methods that will be developed at the completion of this proposed work are expected to provide insights and directions to those problems that we are currently investigating, for example, the dependence of mechanical, diffusive, optical, and magnetic properties of composites on the choice of size, shape, and distribution of particles and the dependence of susceptibility of magnetic colloidal suspensions on the kinetics of the formation of microstructures.
Task Progress:	We have developed a computational framework that is based on Stokesian dynamics and the spectral Ewald method to accurately and efficiently calculate the hydrodynamic and magnetic interactions between particles. We have utilized the computational tool to study the dynamics and rheological properties of magnetic suspensions in relation to the constant magnetic fields and shear flow. Our study has revealed that constrained two-dimensional simulations, which are employed in a previous study, may introduce unphysical artifacts. [Ed. Note: See References below.] The efficient numerical method that is utilized in our study allows us to examine fully three-dimensional systems that can provide more accurate results. The simulations provide the prediction of the viscosity, depending on the strength of the magnetic field and the concentration of the suspensions, allowing us to better process and control magnetic suspensions. We are finishing a study where rotating magnetic fields are applied. In this study, we will focus on the dynamic evolution of the structures and viscosities as a function of the dynamic magnetic fields. We are expanding our computational framework to include non-spherical particles by building rigid assemblies of spheres to mimic non-spherical particles. Because of the flexibility of the method of assembling spheres into different shapes, we are capable of broadening the studies to more realistic systems, where particles possess irregular shapes and polydispersed sizes. REFERENCES R.T. Bonnecaze and J.F. Brady. Dynamic simulation of an electrorheological fluid. The Journal of Chemical Physics, 96(3):2183–2202, 1992.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 10/02/2023)